

Our first project plan

A project charter is a plan that explains the goal, limits, people, and measures for a project. This one records our first meal-plan idea.

Project name and goal

Project title: Campus Dining Meal Plan Initiative

The project aimed to find out whether students would be more interested in buying a campus meal plan if it was flexible and gave them better value for their money. The team planned to validate an idea for students who ate on campus often and students who ate there only sometimes.

What the plan did and did not include

Included in the plan

- Dollar-balance and set-meal structures
- Plan levels for different dining habits
- Rollover for unused value or meals
- Monthly and semester payment options
- Multiple campus dining locations
- Food variety, healthy choices, allergies, and dietary information
- Additional student feedback before implementation

Not included

- Building or launching a complete meal-plan system
- Changing tuition, fees, or university financial policies
- Renovating dining facilities
- Guaranteeing restaurant participation
- Building the payment system
- Changing existing university technology

Saved for later

- Exact pricing for each option
- University ID and payment integrations
- Off-campus restaurants
- Personalized plans and staff management tools
- A production app or web portal
- Campus-wide implementation

What we thought might be true

- The university could offer more than one meal-plan structure.
- Current systems could support a balance, meal count, or hybrid plan.
- Unused value or meals could roll over instead of expiring.
- Monthly payments could be supported.

- Multiple dining locations could participate in the same plan.
- Other students might share the concerns heard in the first interviews.
- A flexible plan could make financial sense for students and campus dining.

These statements were not proven facts. The team planned to test them instead of treating them as confirmed requirements.

People affected by the project

Stakeholder	Interest or responsibility	Influence
Students	Main users and source of feedback	High
Commuter students	Need plans that do not waste unused value	High
Students living on campus	May need larger plans for frequent use	High
Graduate students	May prefer flexible spending for varied schedules	Medium
Campus dining administration	Reviews financial and operational feasibility	High
University administration	Approves policy, payment, and implementation changes	High
Dining locations and vendors	Affected by where and how plan value is used	Medium
Team 10	Conducts research, validation, and documentation	High

How we planned to judge the idea

- At least 80% of students in the next validation round support rollover.
- At least 70% say the proposal offers better value or flexibility than one fixed plan.
- At least two plan approaches address different dining habits.
- The proposal explains payment timing, unused-value rules, and eligible locations.
- Research or later validation supports every major decision.